

Institutional Rules, Standards & Governance — IUC

1. ACCREDITATION & LEGAL STATUS

IUC (Institut Universitaire de la Côte) is a private higher education institution legally established in Cameroon under applicable education laws. It holds the following accreditations:

Accreditation Body	Scope	Significance
CTI — Commission des Titres d'Ingénieur	Engineering degrees	International recognition of engineering programs (France & globally)
CAMES — Conseil Africain et Malgache pour l'Enseignement Supérieur	All programs	Recognition across 19 French-speaking African countries
Cameroonian Ministry of Higher Education	All programs	National operating license

2. ACADEMIC INTEGRITY POLICY

IUC upholds a zero-tolerance stance on academic dishonesty. All students must complete and submit their own original work.

2.1 Prohibited Conduct

- Plagiarism: submitting another's work as one's own without proper attribution
- Cheating: use of unauthorized materials or assistance during examinations
- Fabrication: inventing or falsifying data, sources, or academic records
- Collusion: unauthorized collaboration with another student on individual work
- Impersonation: having someone else sit an examination on one's behalf
- Bribery: offering or accepting gifts/benefits to influence academic decisions

2.2 Disciplinary Procedures

Stage	Description
Investigation	School academic director opens a formal case within 5 days of incident
Hearing	Student is given opportunity to respond in writing or in person
Decision	Academic council issues a written ruling within 10 working days
Appeal	Student may appeal to the Rector within 5 working days of ruling

3. ATTENDANCE POLICY

Regular attendance is mandatory for all scheduled academic activities including lectures, seminars, laboratory sessions, and professional workshops.

- Maximum permissible absences: **20% of total course hours** (unjustified)
- Justified absences: medical certificate required within 48 hours
- Exceeding absence threshold results in disqualification from end-of-semester exams
- Three or more consecutive unjustified absences trigger an administrative alert

4. STUDENT DATA PRIVACY POLICY

IUC collects and processes student personal data for the sole purpose of academic administration, student services, and institutional research. Data is not shared with third parties without explicit consent, except where required by law.

- Data collected: name, contact information, academic records, health information (for health services)
- Data storage: secure servers; student portal access is password-protected
- Data retention: academic records retained permanently; other data for 5 years post-graduation
- Right of access: students may request their personal data from the registrar's office

5. NON-DISCRIMINATION & INCLUSION POLICY

IUC is committed to providing an equal and inclusive educational environment. Discrimination based on gender, nationality, religion, ethnicity, disability, or socio-economic background is strictly prohibited and subject to disciplinary action.

6. HARASSMENT & CONDUCT POLICY

Any form of harassment — physical, verbal, sexual, or psychological — is strictly prohibited. Students experiencing harassment should report to the student affairs office. All reports are treated with confidentiality and investigated promptly.

7. PAYMENT & REFUND POLICY

Tuition fees are due as per the agreed payment schedule. The following refund policy applies for withdrawals:

Withdrawal Timing	Refund Entitlement
Before academic year starts	Full refund minus administrative fee
Within first 2 weeks of classes	75% refund of semester fees
Weeks 3–4 of classes	50% refund of semester fees
After week 4	No refund — full semester fees due

Note: Refund requests must be submitted in writing to the finance office.

8. ENROLLMENT CANCELLATION POLICY

Students wishing to cancel enrollment must notify the admissions/registrar office in writing. Cancellation does not automatically entitle the student to a refund; the refund policy above applies.

9. TRANSFER POLICY

9.1 Incoming Transfer Students

Students transferring from another recognized higher education institution must submit certified transcripts for credit evaluation. Accepted credits reduce the required coursework at IUC. The admissions office manages the

credit transfer process.

9.2 Inter-Campus Transfers

Students may request a transfer between IUC campuses (e.g., from Akwa to Logbessou). Transfers are subject to program availability at the receiving campus and must be approved by the registrar. Inter-campus transfer requests should be submitted before the start of a new semester.

10. APPEALS POLICY

Students have the right to appeal any academic or administrative decision. Appeals must be submitted in writing within 5 working days of the decision. The academic council or rector reviews appeals and communicates outcomes within 15 working days.

11. SOCIAL MEDIA & COMMUNICATIONS POLICY

Students representing IUC on social media or in public forums must do so responsibly. Posts that defame the institution, its staff, or fellow students are subject to disciplinary action. Official IUC communication channels are:

- Facebook: <https://www.facebook.com/lucDouala>
- Instagram: <https://www.instagram.com/lucDouala/>
- LinkedIn: <https://www.linkedin.com/in/iucdouala/>
- X/Twitter: <https://x.com/lucDouala>
- YouTube: @institutuniversitairedelacote